
Introduction

You play an essential role in educating future generations. Think about the goals you set for yourself and the educational goals you determine for students. The teaching methods you use and the way you assess students greatly influence their development.

Perhaps we need to look beyond the current structures of higher education and try to renew these for future generations. We must embrace alternative forms of education to prepare students for the challenges of the future, without overburdening you as teachers.

We propose introducing transdisciplinary innovative learning as a means for you, as a teacher, to regain valuable relationships with students and help them develop the broad skills they need.

You are part of the transdisciplinary team. You learn yourself while guiding students in their development.

Theory

A few examples from the field:

Katusha Sol (University of Amsterdam), Jasper ter Schegget (University of Amsterdam), and Philippa Collin (InHolland University of Applied Sciences) share their experiences with the teaching role in transdisciplinary education.

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Practice

Knowledge development in this area is still emerging, but the following offers a helpful starting point with insights into competencies and an overview of different types of practices.

Competencies You Need

Although there is limited empirical research on the exact requirements of these teaching roles, recent studies (e.g., Veltman et al., 2022; Oonk et al., 2020; Flavian, 2024) highlight the following competencies:

1. **Flexibility and adaptability** in teaching practices, shifting roles as

2. ~~You discipline and control students and the staff, but by the same~~

3. Mediation and communication skills

You maintain relationships with external partners and create a safe space for dialogue between different perspectives.

4. Coaching students

You support students in developing transdisciplinary competencies such as critical thinking, collaboration, and self-reflection.

5. ~~You initiate and provide feedback for self-improvement~~ You maintain open to new forms

6. Dealing with tensions

You help students (and yourself) cope with uncertainty, ambiguity, and tensions that arise when learning together about complex problems.

These competencies take time to develop and highlight the importance of professional space and support within the team and organization. Not every educator immediately feels comfortable in this role — it's important to be open about this and to learn together.

References:

Flavian, H. (2024). Transdisciplinary Teaching: Main Concepts and Perspectives. In Transdisciplinary Teaching in Inclusive Schools: Promoting Transdisciplinary Education for Learners with Special Needs (pp. 1-15). Cham: Springer International Publishing.

Oonk, C., Gulikers, J. T., den Brok, P. J., Wesselink, R., Beers, P. J., & Mulder, M. (2020). Teachers as brokers: adding a university-society perspective to higher education teacher competence profiles. *Higher Education*, 80(4), 701-718/

Veltman, M., Van Keulen, J., & Voogt, J. (2022): Teacher strategies that foster students' boundarycrossing expertise when addressing problems with wicked tendencies, *Journal of Vocational Education & Training*.